Joe LeBlanc

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I'm a Software Engineering Leader with two decades of experience navigating fast-paced startups and enterprise environments. I bridge the gap between leadership stakeholders and technical teams, transforming “surprise” requirements into planned strategic wins. I have a proven track record of leading teams during acquisitions, managing complex release cycles, and fostering inclusive cultures.

Experience

Software Engineering Lead

Emerge Haus (Agency) / Client: PulpitAI (March 2024 - October 2025)
(Note PulpitAI was acquired by Subsplash in November 2024)

- Partnered directly with the non-technical founder to translate a high-level vision for AI-driven ministry tools into a production-ready agentic pipeline, balancing ambitious product goals with technical feasibility and pre-seed round budget constraints.
- Architected and scaled an agentic AI pipeline processing ~1,000 weekly hours of HD video.
- Engineered an LLM-driven flow to analyze metadata in WhisperX transcripts, identify high-engagement 30–90 second segments for social media, and trigger automated downstream processing on GPU nodes.
- Interviewed and led a distributed engineering team of Emerge Haus hires, while managing task allocation, setting technical direction, and fostering high code quality through active pair programming.
- Mitigated operational risk by spearheading a transition to Mux for high-volume asset ingestion, ensuring high-availability during peak Sunday–Tuesday traffic spikes.
- Orchestrated technical due diligence during the $7 million acquisition by Subsplash to mitigate the risk of a failed deal by ensuring codebase health, documentation accuracy, and open-source compliance.

Founder and Product Lead

Pink Wallet (July 2023 - Present)

- Founded West Michigan’s premier LGBTQ+ business directory and discount membership program, moving from an initial digital wallet concept to a sustainable, approachable business model.
- Developed AI workflows for ingesting local event data from highly disparate sources.
- Promoted local events and initiatives as a social media manager.

Software Engineering Manager

FORM (November 2022 - February 2024)

- Scaled a chat-based mobile application on GCP serving frontline retail workers, using SQL profiling tools to identify inefficient Django-generated queries and Kubernetes to spin up surge capacity.
- Managed a remote team of three engineers, focusing on performance feedback and career development.
- Negotiated with quarterly roadmap priorities with Product Managers and coordinated with Sales Engineers to ensure seamless third-party software integrations available through SSO.
- Revived a #queer-collective Slack channel through an ongoing exploration of LGBTQ+ remembrance and awareness days.

Software Engineering Manager

Transfix (March 2022 - October 2022)

- Led a team of 7 remote software engineers in expanding a Fleet Management System (FMS) written in Rails, React, and PostgreSQL.
- Introduced story point estimation and redesigned ticket templates, improving delivery predictability and clarifying requirements.
- Estimated engineering time devoted to roadmap projects in support of capturing capital expenditures vs. operating expenditures.

Software Engineering Manager

True Link (April 2020 - March 2022)

- Led a remote team of 4-7 software engineers, leveling them on a new career ladder with KPIs.
- Managed and participated in Tier 1 support rotations through PagerDuty.
- Reduced production incidents by 59% over six months through process changes, cross-functional communication, and semi-automated workflows.
- Acted as a hiring manager, resulting in offers to multiple candidates, including a Principal Software Engineer.

Senior Fullstack Engineer

True Link (June 2018 - April 2020)

- Expanded a Rails and React codebase hosted on AWS to support new wealth management, budgeting, and spending features in a fast-paced startup environment.
- Communicated with vendors to ensure their product offerings matched our needs and informed internal stakeholders about gaps.
- Advocated for modern coding standards (Rubocop, Prettier) and migrated legacy CoffeeScript to React/Rails.
- Participated in formal Level 1 on-call rotations through PagerDuty.

Software Engineer

BigCommerce (November 2013 - June 2018)

- Maintained billing and provisioning system in Rails, MySQL, and Redis for 60,000+ customers.
- Assessed and implemented the APIs of Zuora, eNom, and several internal services.

Programmer

Sears (June 2013 - November 2013)

- Joined a team to create a real-time analytics tool tracking everything from point-of-sale events to social media mentions.
- Wrote code using Bootstrap, Angular, Node, Express, Grunt, MongoDB, and Kafka.

Programmer

Cory Webb Media (October 2011 - May 2013)

- Built websites and applications for clients including the UN's Sustainable Energy for All initiative, University of Texas Press, and eBay.
- Introduced tools such as Git, LESS, Backbone, and Beanstalk to streamline team development workflows.

Self-Employed Joomla Developer

September 2006 - October 2011, May 2004 - June 2005

- Provided PHP, MySQL, and JavaScript programming services for design agencies, non-profits, federal contractors, NGOs, and the Guggenheim Museum.
- Participated in the Joomla open-source community by writing a plugin tutorial, authoring the "Podcast Suite", and campaigning for a switch to GitHub.

Programmer

The Bivings Group (July 2005 - August 2006)

- Coded new features for a media analytics tool for PR departments at corporations including HP, AMD, Monsanto, and Dow.
- Developed a Listserv-style tool for emailing corporate CEOs and maintained custom LMS/CMS systems.

Publications

Programming in Windsurf and MCP (2025, LinkedIn Learning)
Supabase Essential Training (2024, LinkedIn Learning)
Node.js Essential Training (2013, lynda.com)
Up and Running with PHP: PEAR, PECL, and Composer (2013, lynda.com)
Up and Running with AngularJS (2013, lynda.com)
Up and Running with Backbone.js (2013, lynda.com)
Learning Cloud Storage APIs (2013, lynda.com)
Learning NoSQL Databases (2012, lynda.com)
Node.js First Look (2012, lynda.com)
Joomla! 1.7: Programming and Packaging Extensions (2011, lynda.com)
Joomla! 1.5 Essential Training (2008, lynda.com)
Learning Joomla! 1.5 Extension Development (1st edition 2007, 2nd edition 2008, Packt Publishing)

Volunteering

West Michigan Voices of Pride

January 2025 - Present

- Managed social media campaigns to promote fundraising and seasonal concerts.
- Developed a content calendar recognizing LGBTQ+ remembrance and awareness days.
- Performed with a group of LGBTQ+ singers at concerts and pride festivals.

Vox Veniae

September 2018 – August 2020

- Advised on policies for making the church fully LGBTQ+ inclusive.
- Created budgets for FY 2020 and 2021 and presented quarterly budget status updates to the congregation.
- Tracked Building Fund totals and targets over two fundraising campaigns.
- Implemented a Crucial/Useful/Non-essential budget prioritization framework for expenses.
- Secured a Paycheck Protection Program loan during the COVID-19 crisis.

Education

Oral Roberts University

August 2000 - May 2004
BS, Management Information Systems